

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY RIGHTS (IPR) Copyright Registration Guide for Final-Year IT Engineering Projects

India • Student/Faculty Reference • Updated August 2026

(Important: Academic preparation guide, not legal advice. The current Copyright Office portal, Copyright Act/Rules and institutional IPR policy control if there is any discrepancy.)

1. Purpose

This guide helps final-year IT engineering students identify copyrightable project outputs and prepare a practical document package for online copyright registration in India.

- Computer programmes are a recognized class of copyright work.
- A copyright application is for one work at a time.
- For software, copyright concerns original expression/code; it does not turn an abstract idea or algorithm into copyright.
- Confirm who owns the work before filing—student, joint authors, institution or sponsor.

2. IPR Map for students of an IT Final-Year Capstone Project-II

IP Right	Protects	IT example	Action
Copyright	Original expression	Source code, report, original graphics/video	Prepare work + ownership/authorship record
Patent	Qualifying invention/technical solution	Novel technical method/system	Evaluate and file before public disclosure
Trademark	Brand identifier	Project/product name, logo	Search and assess separately
Design	Qualifying visual features of an article	Novel product enclosure	Consider Designs Act route
Trade secret	Confidential valuable information	Undisclosed calibration/know-how	Confidentiality/access controls
GI	Geographical-origin goods	Usually not ordinary IT projects	Generally not applicable

3. Which Copyright Category Fits?

Project output	Likely class	Prepare	Key point
Web/mobile/desktop software	Computer Software	Source-code PDF + portal forms	Most common IT project
Project report/manual	Literary	Complete original report	Separate work if registration is desired
Original diagrams/illustrations/logo	Artistic	Artwork in required format	Third-party artwork cannot be claimed
Project demo video	Cinematograph Film	Final video + rights record	Follow current portal instructions
Original music/audio	Musical / Sound Recording	Audio + ownership/rights record	Third-party tracks need permission/licence
Database/compilation	Literary/compilation context	Database work + provenance record	Originality/rights must be assessed

Important: Do not confuse a project containing many files with one copyright work. Decide the specific work being registered.

4. What Students Must Not Claim

- Open-source libraries/frameworks as their own.
- GitHub code without checking its licence and rights.
- Third-party datasets, images, icons, fonts, music, videos, APIs or pretrained models merely because they are online.
- The abstract project idea/problem statement as software expression.
- Patent rights merely by registering copyright.

5. Official Online Filing — High-Level Workflow

- Create/login to the official Copyright Office portal.
- Select online Copyright Registration.
- Complete Form XIV and save.
- Keep signatures, work and supporting documents ready for upload.
- Upload the work and required documents.
- Complete Statement of Further Particulars where applicable.
- Pay the prescribed fee through the portal.
- Record the Diary Number and retain the submitted package.
- Monitor status/deficiencies and respond as required.

Important: The official online instructions currently state that uploaded documents should not be password protected. They specify PDF/JPG for artistic works, MP3 for sound recordings, and **PDF for literary/dramatic**, musical and software works. **For software, the portal currently specifies a PDF containing at least the first 10 and last 10 pages of source code, or the entire source code if it is fewer than 20 pages, with no blocked-out/redacted portions.**

6. Software Upload Package

Document	What to prepare	Suggested filename
Software work	Required source-code material	ProjectName_SourceCode.pdf
Source code	First 10 + last 10 pages; or entire code if <20 pages	ProjectName_SourceCode.pdf
Object code	Keep ready; follow current portal field/instruction	ProjectName_ObjectCode.pdf
Form XIV	Applicant/work/ownership particulars	Portal entry + saved copy
Statement of Particulars	Work, author, ownership/publication particulars	Portal entry + saved copy
Statement of Further Particulars	Applicable software particulars	Portal entry + saved copy
NOC/assignment	If author and applicant/owner differ or policy requires	Ownership_NOC.pdf
Third-party register	Open-source/dataset/API/licence audit	ThirdParty_Register.pdf

7. Preparing the Source-Code PDF

- Use the exact software title/version corresponding to the registered work.
- Include a simple cover page identifying title, version/date, applicant/owner and authors.
- Follow the current upload rule: first 10 and last 10 pages, or entire code if fewer than 20 pages.
- Do not black out/redact required source-code pages where the portal prohibits it.
- Use readable formatting and page numbers.
- Do not upload passwords, API keys, private keys, credentials or sensitive personal data. Keep a secure internal evidence copy.
- Retain Git/version-control history and dated development records.

Suggested cover page

```
TITLE: <Exact Software Title>
VERSION/DATE: <Version and date>
CLASS: Computer Software / Computer Programme
APPLICANT/OWNER: <Name>
AUTHORS: <Names>
LANGUAGE(S): <Python/Java/etc.>
PROJECT ID: <Institution ID>
```

8. Authorship vs Ownership

Author and copyright owner can be different. Form XIV and the Statement of Particulars ask for the applicant's interest/ownership information. Confirm the institution's IPR policy, guide/sponsor agreement and any assignment/NOC requirements before filing.

Situation	Verify
Single student creator	Author + ownership
Multiple student creators	Joint authorship/contribution + ownership
Faculty guide involved	Whether actual contribution makes the person an author; title alone is not enough
Institution claims ownership	Institutional policy/authorization/NOC/assignment
Industry-sponsored project	Sponsor ownership, confidentiality and publication clauses
Open-source components	Licence, attribution, modifications and original contribution

9. Practical Document Formats for Student Teams

A. Software Copyright Pack

File	Purpose	Contents
01_Project_Identity.pdf	Identify work	Title, version, applicant, authors, project ID
02_SourceCode.pdf	Primary work	Required source-code pages
03_ObjectCode.pdf	Supporting material	Object/binary material if requested
04_Author_Contribution.pdf	Authorship record	Individual contribution + signatures/date
05_Ownership_NOC_Assignment.pdf	Ownership	NOC/assignment/authorization if applicable
06_ThirdParty_Register.pdf	Rights audit	Component, source, version, licence, use
07_Development_Record.pdf	Evidence	Milestones, Git history, dates
08_ReadMe_Notices.pdf	Software record	Dependencies and third-party notices

B. Literary Work — Report/Manual

Prepare	Suggested contents
Work PDF	Complete original report/manual
Author/owner declaration	Title, authors, ownership, contribution
NOC/assignment	Where author and owner differ
Third-party record	Sources, licences and permissions

C. Artistic Work — Logo/UI Graphics/Illustrations

Prepare	Suggested contents
Source file	SVG/AI/PSD/PNG retained internally
Author/owner record	Creator and ownership
Trademark/design check	Where relevant; copyright is not a substitute
NOC/assignment	Where applicable

D. Demo Video / Cinematograph Film

Prepare	Suggested contents
Final video	Complete work
Script/storyboard	Authorship evidence
Music/media licences	Rights for third-party content
Agreements/NOCs	Where applicable

E. Sound Recording

Prepare	Suggested contents
Final audio	Current portal-supported format
Underlying rights record	Music/lyrics/performer rights where relevant
Agreements/NOCs	Multiple rights holders

10. Form XIV — Student Preparation Sheet

Field/area	Prepare
Applicant	Exact legal name, address, nationality/contact
Interest	Author/owner/other applicable interest
Work title	Exact title matching work
Class	Computer Software / Literary / Artistic etc.
Authors	Accurate author details
Publication	Published/unpublished + details where applicable
Other parties	Details where notice/procedure requires
Enclosures	Work + supporting documents
Signature	Applicant signature as required

Important: Do not replace Form XIV with a student-created form. Use the official Copyright Office form/online workflow.

11. Statement of Particulars — Information to Keep Ready

- Applicant name, address and nationality.
- Nature of applicant's interest.
- Class and description of work.
- Exact title.
- Language; for computer software, the official form instructions ask for the software language.
- Author details.
- Publication status/details if applicable.
- Owners of rights and assignments/licences where relevant.

12. Statement of Further Particulars

The official online instructions state that the Statement of Further Particulars applies to Literary/Dramatic, Musical, Artistic and Software works. Students should use the fields displayed by the current portal rather than relying on old screenshots or third-party forms.

13. Open-Source and Third-Party Material Register

Open-source software remains copyrighted software distributed under licence. Students may be able to use, modify and distribute it under that licence, but cannot claim the upstream work as their own.

Component	Record before filing
Open-source library	Name, version, source, licence, notices, modifications
GitHub code	Repository, author, licence, commit/version, reused/modified portions
Dataset	Provider, version, licence/terms, attribution, restrictions
Images/icons/fonts	Source, licence/permission
Pretrained model	Source, model licence and relevant dataset/licence information
API/service	Terms/licence and output restrictions
AI assistance	Institutional policy, tool terms and human contribution record

14. Patent Timing — Important

If the project contains a potentially patentable technical invention, discuss patent filing before public disclosure. A copyright registration does not substitute for patent protection. A paper, poster, public demonstration, website or repository can create patentability issues depending on the facts.

Project asset	Potential IP
Original source code	Copyright
Novel technical invention	Patentability assessment
Brand/product name	Trademark
Distinctive product appearance	Design
Confidential know-how	Trade secret

15. Final-Year Project Copyright Checklist

- ☐ Final project title is consistent everywhere.
- ☐ Applicant/owner is confirmed under institutional policy.
- ☐ All authors/contributors are accurately identified.
- ☐ Original code is separated/documentated from third-party code.
- ☐ Open-source licenses have been checked.
- ☐ Dataset/images/fonts/models/APIs have been checked.
- ☐ Source-code PDF follows current Copyright Office upload instructions.
- ☐ No prohibited redactions/blocked source-code portions are present.
- ☐ No passwords/API keys/private keys/sensitive credentials are included.
- ☐ NOCs/assignments/agreements are ready where applicable.
- ☐ Form XIV/Statement of Particulars/Statement of Further Particulars information is checked.
- ☐ Uploaded files are not password protected.
- ☐ Patent/IPR cell has been consulted if patentability may exist.
- ☐ Copies of submission, receipt, fee proof and Diary Number are retained.

16. Recommended Project IPR Folder

Folder structure

```
PROJECT_IPR/  
├── 01_Project_Identity/  
│   ├── Project_Title_Ownership.pdf  
│   └── Author_Contribution.pdf  
├── 02_Copyright/  
│   ├── SourceCode.pdf  
│   ├── ObjectCode.pdf  
│   ├── FormXIV_Copy.pdf  
│   ├── StatementOfParticulars_Copy.pdf  
│   └── StatementOfFurtherParticulars_Copy.pdf  
├── 03_ThirdParty/  
│   ├── OpenSource_Register.xlsx  
│   └── ThirdParty_Notices.pdf  
├── 04_Ownership/  
│   ├── NOC.pdf  
│   └── Assignment.pdf  
├── 05_Patent_IF_Applicable/  
│   └── Invention_Disclosure.pdf  
└── 06_Submission_Record/  
    ├── Payment_Receipt.pdf  
    └── Diary_Number.pdf
```

17. Official Government of India Sources

Official resource	Link
Copyright Office — Online Filing/Login	https://copyright.gov.in/UserRegistration/frmLoginPage.aspx
Copyright Office — Form XIV	https://copyright.gov.in/Copyright_Rules_2013/formxiv.html
Copyright Office — General Instructions	https://copyright.gov.in/Copyright_Rules_2013/general_instructions.html
Copyright Rules 2013 — Rule 70	https://copyright.gov.in/Copyright_Rules_2013/chapter_xiii.html
Copyright Office — Download Forms/Documents	https://copyright.gov.in/frmDownloadPage.aspx
Copyright Office — FAQs	https://copyright.gov.in/frmFAQ.aspx
Copyright Office — Handbook of Copyright Law	https://copyright.gov.in/documents/handbook.html

18. Source-Based Notes for Students

The official Copyright Office states that Form XIV is the prescribed application; the Rules require an application to be for one work and specify source-code requirements for computer-programme registration. The online filing instructions provide the current upload formats and software source-code-page instructions. Check these official resources immediately before submission because portal procedures and technical upload requirements can change.

(Note: Prepared for academic IPR awareness and final-year project readiness • India • August 2026)